



FORT STREET HIGH SCHOOL

2020 TRIAL HIGHER SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION

English Extension I

General Instructions

- Reading time - 10 minutes
- Working time – 2 hours
- Write using black or blue pen

Total Marks: 50

Section I - 25 marks (pages 2 - 3)

- Attempt Question 1
- Allow about 1 hour for this section

Section II – 25 marks (pages 4 - 5)

- Attempt Question 2
- Allow about 1 hour for this section

Section I: Common Module — Literary Worlds

25 marks

Attempt Question 1

Allow about 1 hour for this section

In your answer you will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate an understanding of the ideas and values of Literary Worlds and how they are shaped and reflected in texts
 - craft a sustained composition appropriate to the question demonstrating control of the use of language
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Use Text 1 and Text 2 to answer Question 1

Text 1 – Prose Fiction extract

For a while his travelling companion took no notice of the sleeping Charles but as the chin sank deeper and deeper – Charles had taken the precaution of removing his hat – the prophet-bearded man began to stare at him, safe in the knowledge that *his* curiosity would *not* be surprised.

His look was peculiar: sizing, ruminative, more than a shade disapproving, as if he knew very well what sort of man this was (as Charles had believed to see very well what sort of man *he* was) and did not much like the knowledge or the species. It was true that, unobserved, he looked a little less frigid and authoritarian a person; but there remained about his features an unpleasant aura of self-confidence – or if not quite confidence in self, at least a confidence in his judgement in others, of how much he could get out of them, expect from them, tax them.

A stare of a minute or so's duration, of this kind, might have been explicable. Train journeys are boring; it is amusing to spy on strangers; and so on. But this stare which became positively cannibalistic in its intensity, lasted far longer than a minute. It lasted beyond Taunton, though it was briefly interrupted there when the noise on the platform made Charles wake for a few moments. But when he sank back into his slumbers, the eyes fastened on him again in the same leechlike manner.

You may one day come under a similar gaze. And you may – in the less reserved context of our own century – be aware of it. The intent watcher will not wait till you are asleep [...] In my experience there is only one profession that gives that particular look, with its bizarre blend of the inquisitive and the magistral; of the ironic and the soliciting.

Now could I use you?

Now what could I do with you?

It is precisely, it has always seemed to me, the look an omnipotent god – if there were such an absurd thing – should be shown to have. Not at all what we think of as a divine look; but one of a distinctly mean and dubious (as the theoreticians of the *nouveau roman** have pointed out) moral quality. I see this with particular clarity on the face, only too familiar to me, of the bearded man who stares at Charles. And I will keep up the pretence no longer.

Now the question I am asking, as I stare at Charles, is not quite the same as the two above. But rather, what the devil am I going to do with you?

John Fowles

Extract from *The French Lieutenant's Woman*

*A style of avant-garde French novel that came to prominence in the 1950s. It rejected the plot, characters, and omniscient narrator central to the traditional novel in an attempt to reflect more faithfully the sometimes random nature of experience.

Text 2 – Prose Fiction extract

I remained dissatisfied by the story of the second marriage. It had lacked objectivity; it relied too heavily on extremes, and the moral properties it ascribed to those extremes were often incorrect. It was not wrong, for instance, to be jealous of a child, though it was certainly very painful for all concerned. I found I did not believe certain key facts, for instance that his wife had locked his son in the cellar, and nor was I entirely convinced by her beauty, which again seemed to me to have been misappropriated. If it wasn't wrong to be jealous, it certainly wasn't wrong to be beautiful: the wrong lay in the beauty being stolen, as it were, by the narrator, under false pretences. Reality might be described as the eternal equipoise* of positive and negative, but in this story the two poles had become dissociated and ascribed separate, warring identities. The narrative invariably showed certain people – the narrator and his children – in a good light, while the wife was brought in only when it was required of her to damn herself further. The narrator's treacherous attempts to contact his first wife, for instance, were given a positive, empathetic status, while his second wife's insecurity – well founded as we now knew – was treated as an incomprehensible crime. The one exception was the narrator's love for his boring, tornado-swept parents-in-law, a bittersweet detail in which positive and negative regained their balance. But otherwise this was a story in which I sensed the truth was being sacrificed to the narrator's desire to win.

Rachel Cusk
Extract from *Outline*

*Equipoise: equilibrium; counterbalancing thing

Question 1 (25 Marks)

In your response to parts (a) and (b), draw on your understanding of the module Literary Worlds and the extract(s) provided.

(a) Use Text 1 and Text 2 to answer this part. 10

Explore the ways the writers include the reader in the creation of literary worlds.

(b) Use Text 1 to answer this part. 15

Compose an imaginative response that answers the question “What the devil am I going to do with you?”

End of Section I

Section II: Electives

25 marks

Attempt Question 2

Allow about 1 hour for this section

Answer this section in a separate booklet. Extra booklets are available

In your answer you will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate an understanding of the ideas and values of Literary Worlds and how they are shaped and reflected in texts
 - craft a sustained composition appropriate to the question, demonstrating control of the use of language
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Elective 3: Reimagined Worlds (25 marks)

‘We welcome, the world seemed to say; we accept; we create. Beauty, the world seemed to say.’

Virginia Woolf

How do composers challenge and extend our understanding of beauty?

In your response, refer to TWO prescribed texts and TWO related texts of your own choosing.

The Prescribed texts are:

- **Prose Fiction**
 - Italo Calvino, *If on a Winter's Night a Traveller*
 - Ursula Le Guin, *The Left Hand of Darkness*
 - Jonathan Swift, *Gulliver's Travels*
- **Poetry**
 - Samuel Taylor Coleridge, *Samuel Taylor Coleridge: The Complete Poems*

The prescribed poems are:

 - * *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner* (1834)
 - * *The Eolian Harp*
 - * *Kubla Khan*
 - * *Christabel*
 - Tracy K Smith, *Life on Mars*

The prescribed poems are:

 - * *Sci-Fi*
 - * *My God, It's Full of Stars*
 - * *Don't You Wonder, Sometimes?*
 - * *The Universe: Original Motion Picture Soundtrack*
 - * *The Universe as Primal Scream*
- **Film**
 - Guillermo del Toro, *Pan's Labyrinth*

End of Paper